

DURO

DESIGN GROUP

OVERVIEW

Duro Design Group is a full-service architecture and engineering design firm with a proven track record of delivering high-quality, innovative, and efficient solutions for public sector clients. With extensive experience across a broad spectrum of government projects, we proudly serve at the local, state, and regional levels. Our portfolio includes successful engagements with agencies such as the Department of General Services, Prince William Water Authority, and various State Department entities. Our team is equipped to manage projects of diverse scales and complexities — from small-scale municipal improvements to large, multi-phase infrastructure developments. We bring a deep understanding of regulatory requirements, government procurement processes, and stakeholder coordination, ensuring seamless project execution from concept to completion. At Duro Design Group, our mission is to build lasting environments that serve the public good — blending functional design, sustainable practices, and collaborative project delivery. We are committed to being a trusted partner to our government clients, providing dependable service, technical excellence, and visionary design that stands the test of time.



WELCOME TO THE ANCESTORS PAVILION.

The pavilion is the most visible and accessible site for the historic Mount Pleasant Cemetery. It is the only place where visitors can learn about the history of the cemetery and the lives of the people buried there. The pavilion is a small, single-story building with a brick exterior and a gabled roof. It is located on the edge of the cemetery, near the entrance. The pavilion is a small, single-story building with a brick exterior and a gabled roof. It is located on the edge of the cemetery, near the entrance.

WHAT DID THE CEMETERY LOOK LIKE?

The small Mount Pleasant Cemetery occupied the southeast corner of today's vacant field. It was a small, rectangular plot of land, about 100 feet by 100 feet. It was a small, rectangular plot of land, about 100 feet by 100 feet. It was a small, rectangular plot of land, about 100 feet by 100 feet.

THE CEMETERY

The cemetery is a small, rectangular plot of land, about 100 feet by 100 feet. It is a small, rectangular plot of land, about 100 feet by 100 feet. It is a small, rectangular plot of land, about 100 feet by 100 feet.

WHO WAS BURIED THERE?

The cemetery is a small, rectangular plot of land, about 100 feet by 100 feet. It is a small, rectangular plot of land, about 100 feet by 100 feet. It is a small, rectangular plot of land, about 100 feet by 100 feet.

Mount Pleasant Cemetery is a small, rectangular plot of land, about 100 feet by 100 feet. It is a small, rectangular plot of land, about 100 feet by 100 feet. It is a small, rectangular plot of land, about 100 feet by 100 feet.

In 1981, several community members, including descendants of the buried, argued the city for building a new pavilion to serve as a gathering place for the park. The pavilion is a small, single-story building with a brick exterior and a gabled roof. It is located on the edge of the cemetery, near the entrance.

The names of the people buried in the cemetery are listed on the wall of the pavilion. The names are listed in alphabetical order, from A to Z. The names are listed in alphabetical order, from A to Z.

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WALTER PIERCE PARK: PARK UPGRADES

- PROJECT TYPE: LANDSCAPE, HISTORIC PRESERVATION
- CLIENT: DEPARTMENT OF GENERAL SERVICES
- COST OF CONSTRUCTION: \$700,000
- LOCATION: WASHINGTON D.C.
- SIZE: 20,000 SF
- COMPLETED 2024

Walter Pierce Park, located in the heart of Adams Morgan, is a vibrant community space with deep historical significance. Formerly known as the Mount Pleasant Plains Cemetery, the park is the final resting place for over 8,400 African Americans and remains an important cultural site, hosting everything from daily basketball games to annual commemorative visits by descendants of those buried there.

This project proposes improvements to enhance amenities and historical interpretation while respecting the site's heritage. Work includes installation of new historical signage and painting the rear face of the brick wall along Adams Mill Road where the signage will be placed. The project will also add a standalone Portland Loo public restroom at the park entrance—providing a durable, accessible facility designed to blend with its surroundings and address the long-standing lack of public restrooms.



EASTERN MARKET: PRESERVATION

- PROJECT TYPE: HISTORIC PRESERVATION
- CLIENT: DEPARTMENT OF GENERAL SERVICES
- COST OF CONSTRUCTION: \$1,200,000
- LOCATION: WASHINGTON D.C.
- SIZE: 7,000 SF
- COMPLETED 2023

The Eastern Market Preservation Project will address normal wear, tear, and deferred maintenance to ensure the long-term preservation of this historic public space. Work will include revitalizing and refinishing exterior stonework, refreshing existing signage, preserving and updating the skylight, and assessing and repairing the mezzanine floor deck. Additional site improvements and general upgrades will enhance the building's functionality, safety, and appearance, while maintaining its historic character and cultural significance. These efforts will help safeguard Eastern Market's role as a vibrant community gathering place and marketplace for years to come.



HARBOR BANK OF MARYLAND HQ

- PROJECT TYPE: BANK FIT OUT
- CLIENT: HARBOR BANK OF MARYLAND
- COST OF CONSTRUCTION: \$1,000,000
- LOCATION: BALTIMORE, MD
- SIZE: 5,000 SF
- ONGOING

The Harbor Bank of Maryland Headquarters Renovation redefines the bank's physical identity through a contemporary architectural language that merges functionality, brand expression, and community values. The design introduces a cohesive standard to guide future branch renovations—establishing consistent spatial layouts, material palettes, and environmental graphics that reflect the bank's mission of empowerment and trust. Within the headquarters, the renovation prioritizes openness, natural light, and transparency to foster collaboration and connectivity between staff and clients. Modern finishes, integrated technology, and flexible meeting spaces create a professional yet welcoming environment that supports both operational efficiency and customer engagement. This design vision transforms the headquarters into a model for all Harbor Bank facilities, positioning architecture as a tool for communication, identity, and growth.



JUSTICE THURGOOD MARSHALL CENTER

- PROJECT TYPE: CULTURAL, HISTORIC PRESERVATION
- CLIENT: BELOVED COMMUNITY SERVICES CDC, INC.
- COST OF CONSTRUCTION: \$15,000,000
- LOCATION: BALTIMORE MD
- SIZE: 22,000 SF
- COMPLETED 2024

The Amenity Center was a major step forward in establishing the nation's largest Historic African American historic district as a cultural tourism destination to celebrate and honor the community's significance in the nation's Civil Rights Movement. The newly restored Justice Thurgood Marshall Center helps the Upton community actualize its community vision, which commits to "reclaim the vestiges of its distinct African American heritage and be the hub of a cultural revitalization where the memory of the great entertainers, artists and civic leaders who proudly proclaimed Upton as their neighborhood will serve as a beacon by drawing investments back into the community."

Located in the center of Baltimore's Upton community, PS 103 was built in 1877 and was a segregated elementary school for African American children. One of its most recognizable students was Justice Thurgood Marshall, the first African American appointed to the US Supreme Court, who attended the school from 1914 – 1921. PS 103 was a prominent elementary school until it closed in the 1970s.

2024 URBAN LAND INSTITUTE WAVEMAKER AWARD



AFRICAN AMERICAN CIVIL WAR MUSEUM

- PROJECT TYPE: CULTURAL, HISTORIC PRESERVATION
- CLIENT: AFRICAN AMERICAN CIVIL WAR MEMORIAL FREEDOM FOUNDATION
- COST OF CONSTRUCTION: \$3,000,000
- LOCATION: WASHINGTON D.C.
- SIZE: 15,000 SF
- COMPLETED 2023

Built in 1887, the Grimke School in the Greater U Street Historic District of Northwest Washington, DC, is undergoing an adaptive reuse transformation that will create a vibrant mix of office, cultural, and residential spaces. At the heart of this redevelopment will be the new permanent home of the African American Civil War Museum. The project will achieve LEED Silver certification, integrating sustainable practices while preserving the historic character of the building and respecting the surrounding urban fabric.

The museum's new home is being thoughtfully designed to enhance visitor engagement and expand its storytelling capacity. The reimagined space will feature updated, state-of-the-art exhibits, interactive displays, and immersive installations that bring to life the history and contributions of African American soldiers during the Civil War. The design prioritizes accessibility, historical integrity, and flexibility to accommodate future programming, ensuring that the museum continues to serve as an educational and cultural anchor in the community for generations to come.